

The use of survival probabilities is probably best limited to those working with more mathematical utility models to analyze retirement spending decisions. But the complexities of such models mean their insights are best used to describe potential caveats or adjustments for the conclusions derived from the more straightforward approach of using a fixed planning age. When using survival probabilities, the risk of a long life is mitigated by planning to reduce spending with age to account for the reduced likelihood of living beyond a certain age.